



Global Acquisitions

U.S. DEPARTMENT of STATE

JUSTIFICATION FOR OTHER THAN FULL AND OPEN COMPETITION

SECTION 1: IDENTIFICATION OF THE AGENCY AND THE CONTRACTING ACTIVITY

Department of State Contracting Activity

☒ Office of Global Acquisitions, Regional Procurement Support Office
Frankfurt

Requiring Activity

INL Yerevan, Armenia

SECTION 2: NATURE AND/OR DESCRIPTION OF THE ACTION BEING APPROVED

Approval is requested to award a new contract on a sole source basis to “Microring” LLC, located in Yerevan, Armenia, for the supplies and/or services described in Section 3 on behalf of the Requiring Activity.

The identified order type is Firm-Fixed-Price (FFP).

SECTION 3: DESCRIPTION OF SUPPLIES/SERVICES REQUIRED TO MEET THE AGENCY’S NEEDS

This request is for an INL IT assistance project for the Government of Armenia (GOA), which does not have previous acquisition history. This procurement package is what the INL Yerevan team is calling “Phase One” of what will likely be a three-phase procurement package. Phase one focuses on the most essential solutions and mobile equipment that can be quickly installed and deployed to wherever needed.

The request includes open-source intelligence (OSINTs), specialized server, and other IT hardware for data extraction and analysis, specific to law enforcement operations.

The estimated value is \$893,654.00.

SECTION 4: IDENTIFICATION OF THE STATUTORY AUTHORITY PERMITTING OTHER THAN FULL AND OPEN COMPETITION



This statutory authority permitting other than full and open competition is 41 U.S. Code 1901 implemented by FAR 12.000; see also FAR 12.102(b).

SECTION 5: DEMONSTRATION THAT THE PROPOSED CONTRACTOR'S UNIQUE QUALIFICATIONS OR THE NATURE OF THE ACQUISITION REQUIRES USE OF THE AUTHORITY CITED

(a) **URGENCY:** INL has identified this procurement as an immediate and critical priority on behalf of the Government of Armenia (GOA) [REDACTED]. Without this equipment, Armenia will be significantly less able to detect and counter cyber-enabled foreign malign influence [REDACTED]. This procurement directly fulfills commitments made at the Washington Peace Summit and operationalizes White House priorities under the U.S. – Armenia “Crossroads of Peace Capacity Building Partnership” Memorandum of Understanding (MOU), specifically the objective of “Strengthening cyber security best practices and capacities.” Failure to execute this procurement risks endangering the spirit and intent of the MOU, which could cause reputational damage to the United States and strain U.S.–Armenia relations at a sensitive political moment. Market research indicates that delivery of this specialized equipment requires a minimum of 90 days from date of award. [REDACTED]

[REDACTED] Market research further shows that Microring LLC is the only vendor capable of delivering the required products within the necessary timeframe; [REDACTED]

(b) Microring LLC possesses both the unique knowledge and experience required to design, acquire and implement highly complicated technical solutions for intelligence/law enforcement agencies, such as MOIA. [REDACTED]

[REDACTED] Market research showed that Microring LLC is the only in-country vendor capable of fulfilling this requirement.



- (c) Microring LLC also possesses unique certifications and have historically met “know your customer” (KYC) requirements necessitated by vendors such as [REDACTED], which is involved in this procurement. These certifications and requirements by companies such as [REDACTED] are rare, given the nature of the product being highly specialized mobile forensic imaging equipment, making this the only vendor in Armenia with the necessary credentials to acquire it. No other vendor in Armenia possesses the enterprise certifications (listed in the request) from these enterprises.
- (d) Microring LLC was able to develop a Forensic Server based on an AntAnalyzer Intel Enterprise Edition platform running a 5th generation Intel Xeon Scalable Processor, 5th/4th Gen Intel® Xeon® Scalable processors. Some of the technical components specified in the design such as the NVIDIA Quadro RTX PRO 6000 Blackwell Max-Q Workstation Edition OEM-Version 96GB GDDR7 PCIe 5.0 graphics card and the 32-Core Intel CPU Xeon Platinum 8452Y (36C/72T) 2.0 GHz (3.2 GHz Turbo) Tray Socket 4677 E1A TDP 300W with accompanying scalable RAM specifications are extremely difficult to purchase because they are highly customized and curated for specific projects. The forensic server designed by Microring LLC not only sufficiently meets the needs of the Armenia MOIA based on our assessment but is able to be acquired as stated in the procurement paperwork because Microring LLC designed and knows exactly what to obtain. Ordering a unique forensic server from an open market competition cannot be accomplished by the required delivery date.

SECTION 6. DESCRIPTION OF EFFORTS TO ENSURE THAT OFFERS WERE SOLICITED FROM AS MANY POTENTIAL SOURCES AS IS PRACTICABLE, INCLUDING WHETHER A NOTICE WAS OR WILL BE PUBLICIZED AS REQUIRED BY FAR SUBPART 5.1 AND, IF NOT, WHICH EXCEPTION UNDER FAR 5.101(B) APPLIES

Market research for the requirement revealed that Microring LLC expressed capability to provide the full list of requirements. For the reasons stated in paragraph 5 above and further below, it became clear that no other company other than Microring LLC could provide the required supplies and services listed in Phase 1 SoW.

Background: Once the project was authorized by INL SBO, the INL Program Specialist reached out to local IT vendors, who had previously engaged in USG IT contracts through open calls, and requested quotes. In parallel, the INL Program Specialist reached out to the FBI Attache’s Office



asking for an FBI cybercrime expert to review and advise on the equipment list. Additionally, INL Program Specialist reached out to several enterprises to get direct quotes for their specialized products.

Only one local company (Microring LLC) responded to INL market research with a list of technical questions, to be able to build detailed specifications and costs. Other local IT companies, as well as US companies (ex. Cisco) were contacted regarding the requirement. None of the other companies could provide the complete list of requirements. Cisco provided a quote for only a portion of the requirements, however the total cost of the items quoted was 56% higher than the total quote from Microring LLC. The remaining items in the scope of work would need to be purchased from a different source.

SECTION 7. DETERMINATION BY THE CONTRACTING OFFICER THAT THE ANTICIPATED COST TO THE GOVERNMENT IS FAIR AND REASONABLE

The Contracting Office has determined that the anticipated price(s) will be fair and reasonable based on INL Yerevan's market research. By signing the justification, the Contracting Officer makes a determination that the \$893,654.00 price to the Government is expected to be fair and reasonable.

SECTION 8. DESCRIPTION OF THE MARKET RESEARCH CONDUCTED (SEE PART 10) AND THE RESULTS OR A STATEMENT OF THE REASON A MARKET RESEARCH WAS NOT CONDUCTED

See Section 6.

Microring LLC possesses non-disclosure agreements (NDA) and representation certificates from GrayKey/Magnet and other enterprises.

SECTION 9. ANY OTHER FACTS SUPPORTING THE USE OF OTHER THAN FULL AND OPEN COMPETITION

Microring LLC has a clear understanding of the products specifics, technical specifications, is in direct contact with OSINT enterprises, is well-versed in local and international IT sales market, understands USG procurement requirements (based on previous RPSO contracts), is well aware of the high priority nature of this request, and is a trusted vendor that can meet the timeline and deliver the products if not in totality, then in portions by June/ through summer 2026.

**SECTION 10. LISTING OF SOURCES, IF ANY, THAT EXPRESSED A WRITTEN INTEREST IN THE ACQUISITION**

None of the companies included in the market research expressed capability to supply the full list of requirements stated in the SoW.

SECTION 11. STATEMENT OF THE ACTIONS, IF ANY, THE AGENCY MAY TAKE TO REMOVE OR OVERCOME ANY BARRIERS TO COMPETITION BEFORE ANY SUBSEQUENT ACQUISITION FOR THE SUPPLIES OR SERVICES REQUIRED

This request covers only Phase 1 list, requiring sole-source procurement given the nature of required products. INL is planning Phase 2 and Phase 3 procurements for the same laboratory, which will be submitted as separate procurement requests in ARIBA later in 2026, and will be reviewed for viability of competitive procurements.



SECTION 12. CERTIFICATIONS

All reviews and approvals should be completed in the order listed unless otherwise authorized or required.

TECHNICAL AND REQUIREMENTS CERTIFICATION

I certify that the facts and representations under my cognizance which are included in this Justification and its supporting acquisition planning documents, except as noted herein, are complete and accurate to the best of my knowledge and belief.

Technical Cognizance:

SIGNATURE:

Marie Kurth
Acting INL Director
INL/PROG

Requirements Cognizance:

SIGNATURE:

ANDRA BALTA

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BALTA
Date: 2026.03.26 16:41:31
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Andra Balta
Contract Specialist
GA/AM/DMS/RPSO

DAVID D MACHEN

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Date: 2026.03.27 09:23:40 +01'00'

David Machen
Branch Chief
GA/AM/DMS/RPSO



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U.S. DEPARTMENT *of* STATE

CERTIFICATIONS (Continued)

CONTRACTING OFFICER CERTIFICATION (FAR 6.104-1(a)(12))

I certify that this submission is accurate to the best of my knowledge, and that it contains complete information necessary to enable other officials to make an informed recommendation for approval or disapproval.

SIGNATURE:

Travis C Keon

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Date: 2026.03.27 09:50:11

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Travis Keon

Contracting Officer

GA/AM/DMS/RPSO